

ABSTRACT

In the contemporary digital landscape, corporate communication relies heavily on social media platforms to achieve marketing and engagement goals. However, strategies that work effectively on one platform may not translate across cultural or technological contexts. This study investigates how native promotional strategies differ between Weibo in China and X (formerly Twitter) internationally, and how these differences influence user experience.

Using a sequential explanatory mixed-methods design, the research integrates large-scale quantitative content analysis of 189 Weibo and 166 X verified corporate accounts over twelve months with a bilingual user survey ($n = 98$). Results reveal distinct operational paradigms: Weibo follows a high-velocity, event-driven posting model (803.01 vs. 127.14 average daily posts), particularly in sectors such as E-commerce/Retail and Entertainment. The study identifies a “Perception–Volume Paradox,” where Weibo’s high posting volume correlates with more negative user sentiment (41%), while X’s lower volume generates predominantly neutral reactions (68%).

This research extends cross-platform advertising studies by empirically demonstrating how culturally mediated platform design shapes user perception. It contributes methodologically through a data-driven framework linking behavioral and perceptual metrics, and conceptually by clarifying how platform logic and cultural context jointly inform effective social media strategy.